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Lead Platform Engineer

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LOCATION Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science

King Saud University, Riyadh

2011 – 2015 · GPA 3.7/4.0

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2022, renewed 2025)

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — CNCF (2021)

HashiCorp Terraform Associate (2023)

Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS) (2024)

LANGUAGES

Arabic ●●●●●

English ●●●●○

PROFILE

Platform engineer with **11 years of experience** building and operating cloud infrastructure at scale. Currently lead a 5-engineer team running a multi-account AWS landing zone for **12 product teams and 40+ microservices** (900M requests/month). Cut deployment lead time from **4 days to 35 minutes** and delivered **SAR 2.1M** in annual infrastructure savings through a FinOps program. Led the company's **SOC 2 Type II** and **PCI-DSS** readiness to first-attempt audit success.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & IaC AWS (EKS, EC2, RDS, Lambda, VPC, IAM, CloudFront), Terraform, Terragrunt, Helm

Containers & Orchestration Kubernetes (EKS), Docker, ArgoCD (GitOps), Istio service mesh

CI/CD & Scripting GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Python, Go, Bash

Observability Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, ELK, PagerDuty

Security & Compliance SOC 2 Type II, PCI-DSS, HashiCorp Vault, Trivy, least-privilege IAM

Practices SRE (SLOs & error budgets), incident command, FinOps, chaos engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Athar Cloud Systems

Mar 2023 – Present

Lead Platform Engineer · *cloud services provider, 180 employees — Riyadh*

- Lead a team of **5 engineers** operating a multi-account AWS landing zone serving **12 product teams and 40+ microservices**.
- Redesigned the deployment platform around ArgoCD GitOps: lead time **4 days → 35 minutes**; rollback time 45 minutes → under 3 minutes.
- Delivered FinOps program (right-sizing, savings plans, spot for CI runners): infrastructure cost **−38%**, saving **SAR 2.1M/year**.
- Raised platform availability **99.95% → 99.98%** by introducing SLOs, error budgets, and quarterly chaos drills; alert noise reduced −70%.
- Led SOC 2 Type II and PCI-DSS readiness (Terraform guardrails, SCPs, Vault-based secrets): passed **both audits first attempt in 2024**.
- Cut new-engineer onboarding from **3 weeks to 4 days** by authoring the platform handbook and self-service Terraform modules.

Athar Cloud Systems

Jun 2020 – Feb 2023

Senior Site Reliability Engineer

- Built the observability stack (Prometheus/Grafana/Loki) from zero for 28 services: **MTTD 25 min → 90 sec**; MTTR −61%.
- Migrated **22 services** from EC2 virtual machines to EKS with zero-downtime blue/green cutovers over 6 months.
- Served as primary responder on **14 P1 incidents**; authored 9 blameless postmortems; repeat-incident rate −73%.
- Created an org-wide library of **37 Terraform modules**; new environment provisioning 3 days → 40 minutes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Sadaya Systems
Aug 2017 – May 2020

DevOps Engineer · *e-government solutions, 350 employees — Riyadh*

- Built the company's first CI/CD pipelines (GitLab CI + Docker) for 15 .NET/Java applications: release cycle **monthly → weekly**.
- Automated infrastructure with Terraform and Ansible: server provisioning **6 hours → 15 minutes**; configuration-drift incidents −90%.
- Replaced legacy Zabbix monitoring with Prometheus: unplanned downtime **−45%** in the first year.
- Supported a PCI-DSS audit for the payments gateway: remediated **63 findings** on schedule.

Al-Manara Group
Jul 2015 – Jul 2017

IT Systems Administrator · *diversified holding, 2,400 employees — Riyadh*

- Administered **300+ Windows/Linux servers** across 4 data centers; quarterly DR tests achieved a 4-hour RTO.
- Led VMware consolidation of 180 hosts down to 60 (**capex −28%**).
- Automated patching with PowerShell/WSUS: patch compliance **62% → 97%**.

PROJECTS & COMMUNITY

- **terraform-ksa-modules** — open-source production-grade Terraform module library (**280+ GitHub stars**).
- Speaker, **Kubernetes Riyadh** meetup (2024): “GitOps at Scale with ArgoCD.”
- Author of the internal Athar Platform Handbook — the reference onboarding guide for 12 product teams.